

# Allow and prohibit

## Learner workbook

Explain permission and restrictions clearly.

## Understand the distinction

Allow commonly takes a person plus to + verb: They allow visitors to take photos. Without a named person, use an -ing form: They allow photography / taking photos. The passive is be allowed to.

Prohibit commonly takes an activity or person + from + -ing: The rules prohibit parking here; they prohibit visitors from entering. Must not expresses a prohibition. Do not have to expresses lack of obligation, which is different.

## Compare the patterns

### PERMISSION

Visitors are allowed to take photos.

Taking photos is permitted.

### PROHIBITION

Parking here is prohibited.

Parking here is not permitted.

### NO OBLIGATION

You do not have to print the ticket.

Printing is optional, not forbidden.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

## Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. Complete: They allow us \_\_\_ leave early.

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2. Complete: The rule prohibits staff from \_\_\_ here. (smoke)

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3. Does You do not have to wait mean waiting is forbidden?

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## Use it in your own life

Write one permission and one restriction for a shared space.

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### Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

### Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

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## Answers and explanation

### 1. to

Use allow someone to do something.

### 2. smoking

Use from + -ing.

### 3. No. Waiting is not required.

Use must not wait if it is prohibited.

### One possible response

You may use the kitchen. You must not leave the door unlocked.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

### Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: [englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-13.html](https://englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-13.html)